

Tagalog Academy Beginner Guide

Practical words, phrases, and patterns from the complete learning path.

Learn · Recall · Speak · Use

Lesson 1: Greetings and Introductions

Greet people, introduce yourself, and talk about how you feel.

Tagalog	English	Note
Kumusta?	How are you?	Kamusta? is also common in everyday writing.
Magandang umaga.	Good morning.	
Magandang hapon.	Good afternoon.	
Magandang gabi.	Good evening.	
Ayos lang ako.	I am okay.	Okay lang ako is also natural and common.
Masaya ako.	I am happy.	
Malungkot ako.	I am sad.	
Inaantok ako.	I am sleepy.	
Nasasabik ako.	I am excited.	Often expresses anticipation.
Gutom ako.	I am hungry.	
Na-stress ako.	I am stressed.	Everyday Taglish alternatives such as "Stressed ako" and "Nai-stress ako" also appear in use.
Pagod ako.	I am tired.	
Ano ang pangalan mo?	What is your name?	
Ako si ____.	I am ____.	Use this before a personal name.
Taga-saan ka?	Where are you from?	
Taga-____ ako.	I am from ____.	
Saan ka nag-aaral?	Where do you study?	
Nag-aaral ako sa ____.	I study at ____.	
Ano ang inaaral mo?	What are you studying?	
Nag-aaral ako ng ____.	I am studying ____.	A natural pattern for a subject or field.
Saan ka nagtatrabaho?	Where do you work?	
Nagtatrabaho ako sa ____.	I work at ____.	
Ano ang trabaho mo?	What is your job?	
____ ako.	I am a/an ____.	Example: Inhinyero ako. You can also say: Ang trabaho ko ay ____.
Salamat!	Thank you!	
Paalam!	Goodbye!	
Ingat ka!	Take care! (one person)	
Ingat kayo!	Take care! (plural or respectful)	

Useful patterns

Ako si [pangalan].
I am [name].

Taga-[lugar] ako.
I am from [place].

[Pakiramdam] ako.
I am [feeling].

Lesson 2: People and Family

Name family relationships and describe people clearly.

Tagalog	English	Note
Nanay	Mother	Common everyday form.
Ina	Mother	Formal or literary form.
Tatay	Father	Common everyday form.
Ama	Father	Formal or literary form.
Kuya	Older brother	Also used respectfully for an older male.
Ate	Older sister	Also used respectfully for an older female.
Bunso	Youngest child or sibling	
Kapatid	Sibling	
Lolo	Grandfather	
Lola	Grandmother	
Tiyo	Uncle	Standard form.
Tito	Uncle	Very common everyday form.
Tiya	Aunt	Standard form.
Tita	Aunt	Very common everyday form.
Pinsan	Cousin	
Kaibigan	Friend	
Katrabaho	Coworker	
Kasamahan	Colleague or companion	
Kakilala	Acquaintance	
Kapitbahay	Neighbor	
Kasintahan	Romantic partner	
Asawa	Spouse	
Kababayan	Person from the same country, town, or community	
Ito si Maria. Kaibigan ko siya.	This is Maria. She is my friend.	
Mabait	Kind	
Maganda	Beautiful	
Gwapo	Handsome	
Masayahin	Cheerful	
Matalino	Smart	
Masipag	Hardworking	
Nakakatawa	Funny	
Matangkad	Tall	
Mabuti	Good	
Palakaibigan	Friendly	
Matulungin	Helpful	
Tahimik	Quiet	

Useful patterns

Ito si [pangalan]. [Ugnayan] ko siya.

This is [name]. They are my [relationship].

[Pang-uri] siya.

They are [adjective].

Lesson 3: Colors and Preferences

Name colors and express what you like or dislike.

Tagalog	English	Note
Pula	Red	
Asul	Blue	Common everyday form.
Bughaw	Blue	Native alternative.
Berde	Green	Common everyday form.
Luntian	Green	Native alternative.
Dilaw	Yellow	
Itim	Black	
Puti	White	
Lila	Purple	Common color term.
Kulay ube	Purple	Literally "ube-colored."
Rosas	Pink	Common color term.
Kulay rosas	Pink	Literally "rose-colored."
Kahel	Orange (color)	Color term.
Kulay dalandan	Orange (color)	Literally "dalandan-colored."
Kayumanggi	Brown	
Kulay abo	Gray	Literally "ash-colored."
Abo	Gray	Short form used for gray.
Ano ang paborito mong kulay?	What is your favorite color?	
Anong kulay ito?	What color is this?	
Anong kulay iyan?	What color is that?	
Pula ang paborito kong kulay.	Red is my favorite color.	
Gusto ko ng asul.	I like blue.	
Ayaw ko ng rosas.	I do not like pink.	
Gusto mo ba ng berde?	Do you like green?	

Useful patterns

[Kulay] ang paborito kong kulay.

[Color] is my favorite color.

Pulang tasa. / Asul na tasa.

Red cup. / Blue cup.

Lesson 4: Food and Drinks

Name everyday food and drinks and talk about preferences.

Tagalog	English	Note
Kanin	Rice	
Tinapay	Bread	
Manok	Chicken	
Baboy	Pork	
Isda	Fish	
Gulay	Vegetables	
Prutas	Fruit	
Mansanas	Apple	
Saging	Banana	
Tubig	Water	
Kape	Coffee	
Tsaa	Tea	
Gatas	Milk	
Ano ang paborito mong pagkain?	What is your favorite food?	
Ano ang gusto mong kainin?	What do you want to eat?	
Ano ang gusto mong inumin?	What do you want to drink?	
Gusto ko ng kanin.	I like or want rice.	
Ayaw ko ng isda.	I do not like fish.	
Busog ako.	I am full.	
Hindi ako kumakain ng isda.	I do not eat fish.	

Useful patterns

[Pagkain] ang paborito kong pagkain.
[Food] is my favorite food.

Gusto ko ng [pagkain o inumin].
I want or like [food or drink].

Lesson 5: Home and Location

Name household objects and say where people and things are.

Tagalog	English	Note
Kutsara	Spoon	
Tinidor	Fork	
Kutsilyo	Knife	
Plato	Plate	Common everyday form.
Pinggan	Plate	Common alternative.
Mangkok	Bowl	
Baso	Glass	
Tasa	Cup	
Bote	Bottle	
Kama	Bed	
Unan	Pillow	
Kumot	Blanket	
Sipilyo	Toothbrush	
Tuwalya	Towel	
Salamin	Mirror	Salamin can also mean eyeglasses; context matters.
Sabon	Soap	
Kusina	Kitchen	
Sala	Living room	
Kwarto	Bedroom or room	
Banyo	Bathroom	
Garahe	Garage	
Hardin	Garden	
Nasaan ang kutsara?	Where is the spoon?	
Nasaan ang kama?	Where is the bed?	
Nasaan si Maria?	Where is Maria?	
Nasa kusina ang kutsara.	The spoon is in the kitchen.	
Nasa kwarto ang kama.	The bed is in the bedroom.	
Nasa opisina si Maria.	Maria is in the office.	
Kwarto ko ito.	This is my room.	
Backpack ko ito.	This is my backpack.	
Malaki	Big	
Maliit	Small	
Mahaba	Long	
Makapal	Thick	

Useful patterns

Nasaan ang [bagay]?
Where is the [object]?

Nasa [lugar] ang [bagay].
The [object] is in the [place].

Nasaan si [pangalan]?
Where is [name]?

Lesson 6: Numbers and Quantities

Count, recognize common tens, and ask how many.

Tagalog	English	Note
Isa	One	
Dalawa	Two	
Tatlo	Three	
Apat	Four	
Lima	Five	
Anim	Six	
Pito	Seven	
Walo	Eight	
Siyam	Nine	
Sampu	Ten	
Labing-isa	Eleven	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labindalawa	Twelve	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labintatlo	Thirteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labing-apat	Fourteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labinlima	Fifteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labing-anim	Sixteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labimpito	Seventeen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labingwalo	Eighteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Labinsiyam	Nineteen	Standard assimilated spelling used for typed recall.
Dalawampu	Twenty	
Tatlumpu	Thirty	
Apatnapu	Forty	
Limampu	Fifty	
Animnapu	Sixty	
Pitumpu	Seventy	
Walumpu	Eighty	
Siyamnapu	Ninety	
Isang daan	One hundred	

Useful patterns

Ilang [bagay]?
How many [things]?

Limang [bagay].
Five [things].

Lesson 7: Fruit and the Market

Name fruit and complete a simple market exchange.

Tagalog	English	Note
Mangga	Mango	
Dalandan	Orange fruit	Dalandan names a citrus fruit; kahel is used for the color orange in the Colors and Preferences lesson.
Ubas	Grapes	
Pinya	Pineapple	
Pakwan	Watermelon	
Peras	Pear	
Papaya	Papaya	
Kalamansi	Calamansi	
Magkano ang mangga?	How much is the mango?	
Ilang mangga?	How many mangoes?	
Limang mangga ang gusto ko.	I want five mangoes.	
Dalawampung piso.	Twenty pesos.	
Magkano lahat?	How much is everything?	
Talaga?	Really?	
Siyempre.	Of course.	
Tama.	Correct.	
Mali.	Incorrect.	
Sige.	Okay or go ahead.	
Sandali.	Wait a moment.	
Ayos!	Great!	
Walang problema.	No problem.	

Useful patterns

Magkano ang [prutas]?

How much is the [fruit]?

Pabili po ng [prutas].

I would like to buy [fruit], please.

Lesson 8: Days and Time

Talk about days, time, and a simple schedule.

Tagalog	English	Note
Lunes	Monday	
Martes	Tuesday	
Miyerkules	Wednesday	
Huwebes	Thursday	
Biyernes	Friday	
Sabado	Saturday	
Linggo	Sunday	
Araw	Day	
Oras	Time	
Ngayon	Now; today in context	Context determines whether it means “now” or “today.”
Kahapon	Yesterday	
Bukas	Tomorrow	
Tuwing	Every; each	
Umaga	Morning	
Hapon	Afternoon	
Gabi	Evening or night	
Tanghali	Noon	
Hatinggabi	Midnight	
Ala una	1:00	
Alas dos	2:00	
Alas tres	3:00	
Alas kuwatro	4:00	
Alas singko	5:00	
Alas seis	6:00	
Alas siyete	7:00	
Alas otso	8:00	
Alas nuwebe	9:00	
Alas diyos	10:00	
Alas onse	11:00	
Alas dose	12:00	
Anong araw ngayon?	What day is it today?	
Lunes ngayon.	Today is Monday.	
Anong oras na?	What time is it?	
Alas dos na.	It is two o'clock.	
Anong oras ang klase?	What time is the class?	
Alas tres ang klase.	The class is at three o'clock.	

Useful patterns

Anong araw ngayon?
What day is it today?

Anong oras na?
What time is it?

Tuwing Lunes, alas tres ang klase ko.
Every Monday, my class is at three.

Lesson 9: Daily Routine

Describe completed morning activities in order.

Tagalog	English	Note
Gumising ako.	I woke up.	Completed aspect.
Bumangon ako.	I got up.	Completed aspect.
Nagsipilyo ako.	I brushed my teeth.	Completed aspect; not a neutral dictionary infinitive.
Naghilamos ako.	I washed my face.	Completed aspect.
Naligo ako.	I took a bath or shower.	Completed aspect.
Nagbihis ako.	I got dressed.	Completed aspect.
Nagsuklay ako.	I combed my hair.	Completed aspect.
Nag-almusal ako.	I ate breakfast.	Completed aspect.
Uminom ako ng tubig.	I drank water.	Completed aspect.
Uminom ako ng kape.	I drank coffee.	Completed aspect.
Umalis ako sa bahay.	I left the house.	Completed aspect; sa marks the place left.
Pumasok ako sa trabaho.	I went to work.	Completed aspect.
Pumasok ako sa paaralan.	I went to school.	Completed aspect.
Anong oras ka gumising?	What time did you wake up?	
Ano ang ginawa mo pagkatapos?	What did you do next?	
Ano ang ininom mo?	What did you drink?	
Gumising ako ng alas seis.	I woke up at six o'clock.	
Nag-almusal ako ng alas siyete.	I ate breakfast at seven o'clock.	
Pumasok ako sa trabaho ng alas otso.	I went to work at eight o'clock.	

Useful patterns

Nagsipilyo ako.
I brushed my teeth.

Gumising ako ng alas seis.
I woke up at six o'clock.

Ano ang ginawa mo pagkatapos?
What did you do next?